Alexander Walker

Reflection Paper 2

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Old Dominion University

Professor Teresa Duvall/TA Joshua Russell

Job Reflection Paper First

150 Hours

Having continued working as a remote support specialist, I am confident that I have completed my training and I am already working independently. Compared to my first 100 hours which were full of following someone around and becoming familiar with the environment, now I grab tickets from the queue all by myself and deal with them independently throughout the whole process. Having made such a great step towards developing my skills, I want to emphasize what an enormous improvement has occurred within me since I joined the team.

In about two weeks time, I have handled up to 60 tickets. It was very hectic indeed, but also fun as I am very much used to the process now. The tickets that I have handled were quite familiar to what I had dealt with before, which include installation of software, printer problems, problems with syncing the OneDrive, microphone problems etc. Even though most problems were recurring, they always differed a little bit, hence posing a challenge for me as well.

One of the most significant experiences during this period has been working with software deployment through Intune and Entra. The software we use needs to be repackaged and pushed out roughly every six months, and Aaron, who manages Intune and Entra, trusted me with helping deploy this update. I have been repackaging and preparing deployments across 12 different groups, covering a range

of about 11,000 devices. I have also been actively rolling out these updates through Intune. This responsibility has been extremely valuable to me because I have been wanting to deepen my understanding of Intune and Entra, especially since I have used these tools both in this role and in my previous job. Being directly involved in a large-scale deployment has given me hands-on experience that goes beyond basic support tasks.

Another aspect where improvement can easily be noticed is communication. Initially, during my experience, I had to pay close attention to properly explaining the process of the solution that was required from the user. Now, it all comes very easily to me. I can now assist the users much easier and communicate much better, both with the users and with my colleagues. My entire shift revolves around conversations where we talk about different things, share our thoughts, and help one another solve the issue at hand. This has made a significant contribution to our ability to resolve tickets effectively.

Overall, this stage of my experience has shown how much progress I have made. I have gone from observing and learning to fully handling tickets independently and even contributing to larger projects like system-wide software deployments. The combination of technical growth, improved communication, and stronger teamwork has made this period both productive and rewarding. I feel much more prepared for future roles in IT and cybersecurity because I now have real-world experience not only solving problems, but also managing responsibilities at a larger scale.